

Warehouse Safety Standard Operating Procedure

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1. Personal Protective Equipment

The following PPE is mandatory for all personnel entering the warehouse floor, including visitors, auditors and contractors:

- High visibility vest, worn fastened at all times.
- Steel toe-capped safety boots.
- Hard hat in all racking aisles and any area where overhead work is in progress.
- Cut resistant gloves when handling strapped or banded pallets.
- Safety glasses when operating strapping or shrink wrapping equipment.

PPE is issued by the depot supervisor and replaced on request at no cost to the employee. Entry to the floor without the required equipment is refused by the gate marshal.

2. Forklift Operation

Only employees holding a current Meridian forklift certification may operate a forklift. Certification requires completion of the internal two day course, a practical assessment, and revalidation every twenty four months. A register of certified operators is maintained by the depot supervisor and displayed at the charging bay.

- Pre-shift inspection of forks, mast, hydraulics, horn and brakes is mandatory and recorded on the daily check sheet.
- Maximum speed on the warehouse floor is 8 km/h; 5 km/h in pedestrian crossover zones.
- Loads must be carried with the mast tilted back and the forks no more than 15 cm above the floor.
- Passengers are never permitted on a forklift under any circumstance.
- Keys must be removed and the unit returned to the charging bay at the end of every shift.

3. Racking and Manual Handling

Pallets exceeding 25 kg require mechanical assistance. Racking must not be climbed under any circumstances; a certified order picker or approved ladder must be used. Damaged racking is tagged out immediately and reported to the depot supervisor, who arranges inspection before the bay is returned to service.

4. Incident Reporting

All incidents, including near misses with no injury or damage, must be reported. The procedure is as follows:

- **Step 1.** Make the area safe and, where anyone is injured, summon first aid immediately.
- **Step 2.** Notify the shift supervisor verbally without delay.
- **Step 3.** Complete incident form IR-01 within 24 hours of the event.
- **Step 4.** The supervisor submits the form to the Safety Officer, who logs it in the incident register.
- **Step 5.** The Safety Officer completes a root cause review within five working days for any incident involving injury, vehicle contact or product loss.

- **Step 6.** Corrective actions are assigned with an owner and a due date, and reviewed at the monthly operations meeting.

Failure to report an incident is treated as a disciplinary matter. No employee will face adverse consequences for reporting a near miss in good faith.

5. Fire and Evacuation

Assembly point A is located at the north gate car park. On hearing the alarm, staff stop work, shut down equipment where it is safe to do so, and proceed to the assembly point by the nearest marked route. Drills are conducted quarterly. Fire extinguishers are inspected monthly by the Safety Officer and the inspection tag is signed and dated.